

Java Getting Started

Your journey from "Zero" to "Hello World"

1. The Quickest Start (Online Editor)

The easiest way to jump into Java without any setup is using a browser-based editor like W3Schools or Replit.

```
public class Main {  
    public static void main(String[] args) {  
        System.out.println("Hello World");  
    }  
}
```

Result: Hello World

2. Installing Java locally

To check if Java is already on your system, open your **Command Prompt (cmd)** and run:

```
> java -version
```

If you see **java version "22.0.0"** (or similar), you are ready. If not, download the **JDK** from the official Oracle website.

3. Choosing an IDE (Recommended)

While you can use Notepad, Professional developers use **Integrated Development Environments**:

- **IntelliJ IDEA**: The industry standard.
- **Eclipse**: Powerful and free.
- **VS Code**: Lightweight with Java extensions.

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4. Your First Real Program

Follow these steps to create a local Java file:

- 1 Create a new text file.
- 2 Paste the "Hello World" code into it.
- 3 Save it exactly as: `Main.java`

5. Compiling and Running

Java is a compiled language. You must convert your text into *Bytecode* before running it.

Step A: Compile

Navigate to your folder in the Command Prompt and type:

```
> javac Main.java
```

(This creates a Main.class file)

Step B: Run

Run the compiled bytecode using the java command:

```
> java Main
```

Output: Hello World

6. The Process Explained

Main.java (Source) → **javac** (Compiler) → **Main.class** (Bytecode) → **JVM** (Runner)

This process is why Java is **Platform Independent**. The *Bytecode* can be carried to any machine with a JVM and it will run exactly the same way.



Congratulations! You have successfully mastered the basics of Java setup.
Next stop: Variables and Data Types!

Practice daily. Every expert was once a beginner.

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